



Module 11 Lecture - Personality

Introductory Psychology

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Table of Contents

1	Overview and Introduction	2
1.1	Textbook Learning Objectives	2
1.2	Instructor Learning Objectives	2
1.3	Introduction	2
2	What is Personality?	3
2.1	Introduction	3
2.2	Historical Perspectives	3
3	Freud and the Psychodynamic Perspective	6
3.1	Introduction	6
3.2	Levels of Consciousness	6
3.3	Defense Mechanisms	9
3.4	Stages of Psychosexual Development	11
3.4.1	Oral Stage	12
3.4.2	Anal Stage	12
3.4.3	Phallic Stage	13
3.4.4	Latency Stage	14
3.4.5	Genital Stage	14
3.5	Conclusion	14
4	Neo-Freudians: Adler, Erikson, Jung, and Horney	15
4.1	Introduction	15
4.2	Alfred Adler & Individual Psychology	15
4.3	Erik Erikson (Again)	15
4.4	Carl Jung & Analytical Psychology	16
4.5	Karen Horney & Extension of Psychoanalysis	16
5	Learning Approaches	17
5.1	Introduction	17
5.2	Behavioral Perspective	18
5.3	Social-Cognitive Perspective	19
6	Conclusion	20
6.1	Recap	20
	Key Terms	20
	Key Terms	22

1 Overview and Introduction

1.1 Textbook Learning Objectives

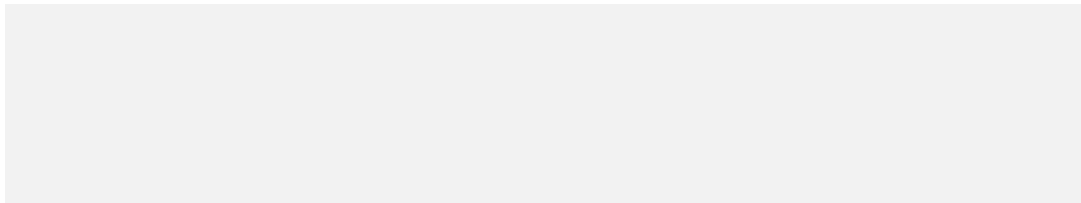
- Define personality
- Describe early theories about personality development
- Describe the assumptions of the psychodynamic perspective on personality development
- Define and describe the nature and function of the id, ego, and superego
- Define and describe the defense mechanisms
- Define and describe the psychosexual stages of personality development
- Discuss the concept of the inferiority complex
- Discuss the core differences between Erikson's and Freud's views on personality
- Discuss Jung's ideas of the collective unconscious and archetypes
- Discuss the work of Karen Horney, including her revision of Freud's "penis envy"
- Describe the behaviorist perspective on personality
- Describe the cognitive perspective on personality
- Describe the social cognitive perspective on personality

1.2 Instructor Learning Objectives

- Be able to classify theories under the general category they belong to, and identify the perspective/paradigm that the respective theorists belong to
- Appreciate the complexity of different perspectives in personality theories - compare and contrast this with the diverse theories of learning, development, etc.
- Be able to differentiate between the different foci of different theories, and use the correct vocabulary when describing them

1.3 Introduction

 Discuss: Think of your closest friend or acquaintance - in single word, e.g. 'mean', give some descriptors of their personality



- We have an _____ sense of people's personality, but a whole field of _____ research has much clearer explanations of the *how* and *why* our personality is the way it is

2 What is Personality?

2.1 Introduction

- Our **personality** is a set of _____ traits and patterns of thoughts, feelings, and behaviors that drive our _____ with others and play into our outcomes in life
 - But within that broad perspective, there are a lot of different _____ and _____ as to the *how* and *why*

? If we are to describe personality as being 'long-standing', which of the following things is most likely a personality trait

- ☒ A) Depressive mourning following the death of a loved one
- ☐ B) Bliss from finishing a college semester
- ☐ C) Chronic aggression towards friends and family
- ☐ D) Frustration from a home-work problem

Explanation:

! Important

It's been said several times before, but having many theories to explain the same observations is a common situation in psychological science

2.2 Historical Perspectives

- Like early _____ opining on the human behavior and mind, they also gave many theories regarding _____
- The **four-humors theory**: personality is based upon the relative _____ 4 different fluids in the body

- An _____ of these fluids could result in bad personality or behavior - balance was desired
- _____ temperament: yellow bile from the liver; ambition, short-tempered, aggressive
- _____ temperament: black bile from the kidney; sadness, depression
- _____ temperament: red blood from the heart; enthusiastic, social, active
- _____ temperament: white phlegm from the lungs; reserved

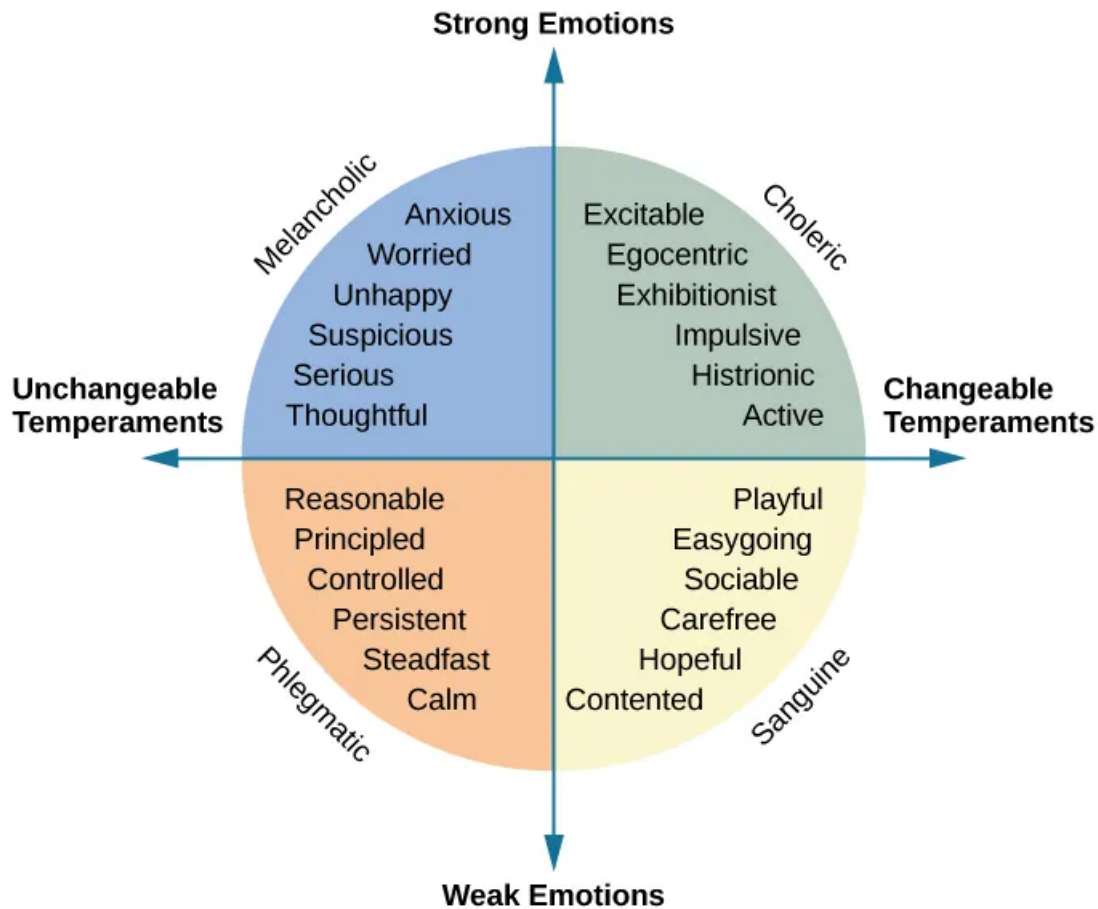
? Under the four humors theory, which of the following behaviors would like be associated with too high amount of red blood

- ☒ A) Sulking around and not leaving the house
- ☐ B) Being overly flamboyant, loud, passionate
- ☐ C) Being too shy to talk to new acquaintances
- ☐ D) Always trying to get promoted at work, to others' expense

Explanation:

🗣 Discuss: The four humors theory hinges on 'balance' of the fluids - what more modern idea in psychology and physiology is also connected to balance of things in our body?

- **Phrenology theory** personality and _____ can be understood by taking many _____ of the skull that, hypothetically, described the underlying brain
- Galen's theory:



! Important

While these may seem far-fetched today, they were well-respected theories for some time! There are likely to be modern theories in medicine in psychology that we will laugh at 30 years from now.

3 Freud and the Psychodynamic Perspective

3.1 Introduction



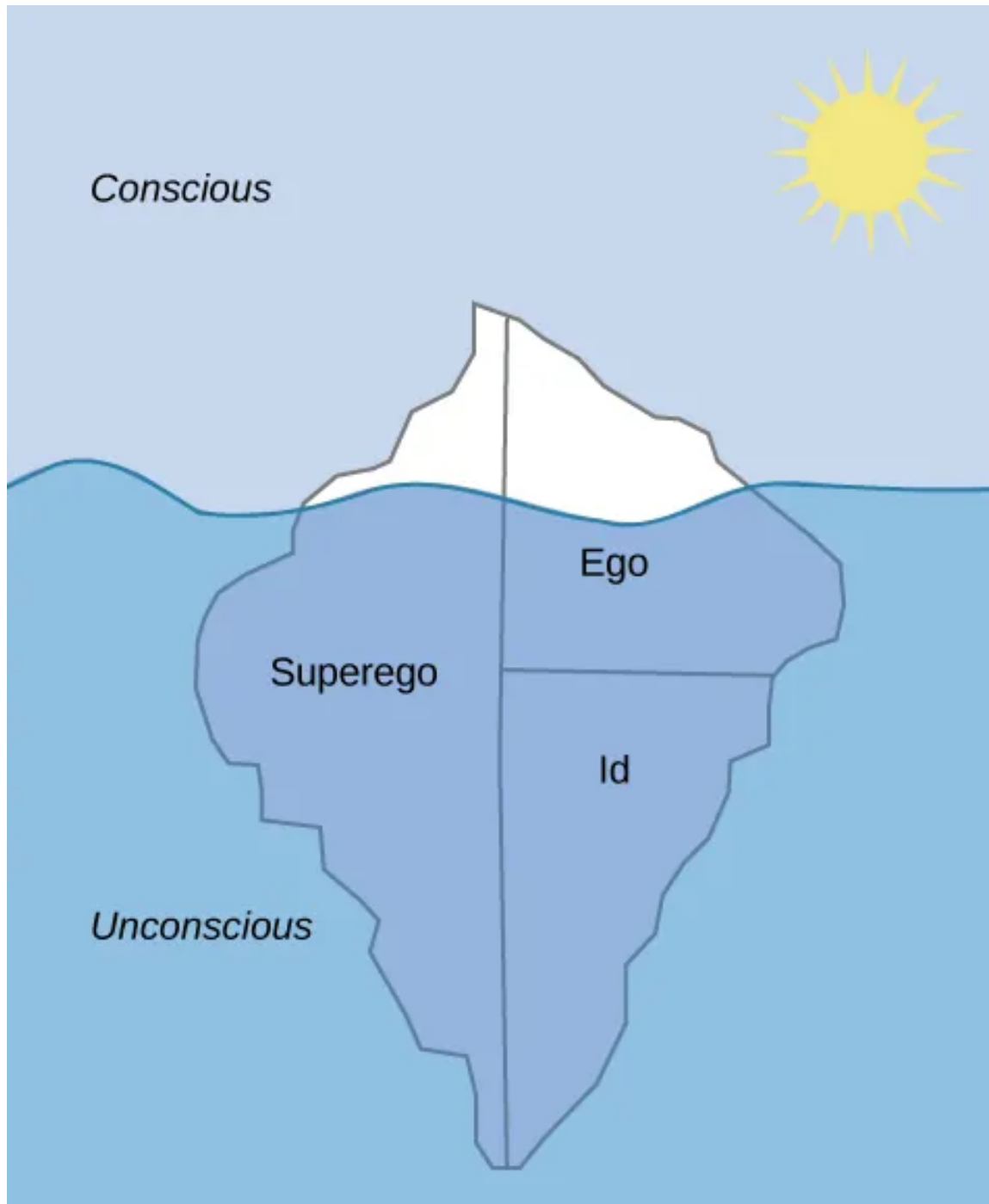
- Much like Freud had ideas on _____, the _____ and _____, he also had something to say about personality
- Freud's early foray into the psychological came with the study of Anna O., a pseudonym for Bertha Pappenheim
 - He hypothesized that she suffered _____ symptoms like, hallucinations and amnesia related to past _____ and _____
 - But, this trauma had been _____ in the unconscious, "Anna" was not aware of it

! Important

Remember, with Freud it always comes back to the unconscious!

3.2 Levels of Consciousness

- In Freud's view, there are levels between our conscious and unconscious



- The **conscious** is what , feelings, and memories we are aware of, while the **unconscious** are things we are not aware of, or cannot access.

 Discuss: Write down an unconscious memory you have of your childhood

- In Freud's view, our personality is related to the _____ between three components:
 - _____
 - _____
 - _____
- The **Id**
 - _____ drives, urges instincts and needs
 - Works on the **pleasure principle**

 Discuss: Which theory of motivation dealt with concepts similar to the above description of the id?

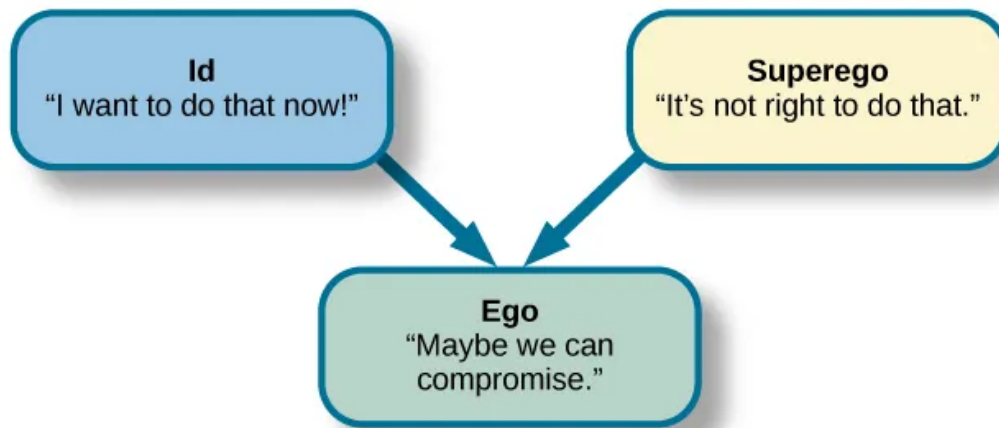
- The **Superego**
 - Acts as our _____ and moral compass
 - Causes feelings of _____ when we do something wrong or indecent

 Important

Because of their opposite natures, our id and superego are always in conflict with one another!

- The **Ego**
 - Balances the desires of both the _____ and the _____ by being rational

- Works on the **reality principle**



? In class, I am hungry, so I pull out a triple hamburger and begin eating it as I lecture - what part of the above trio am I listening to?

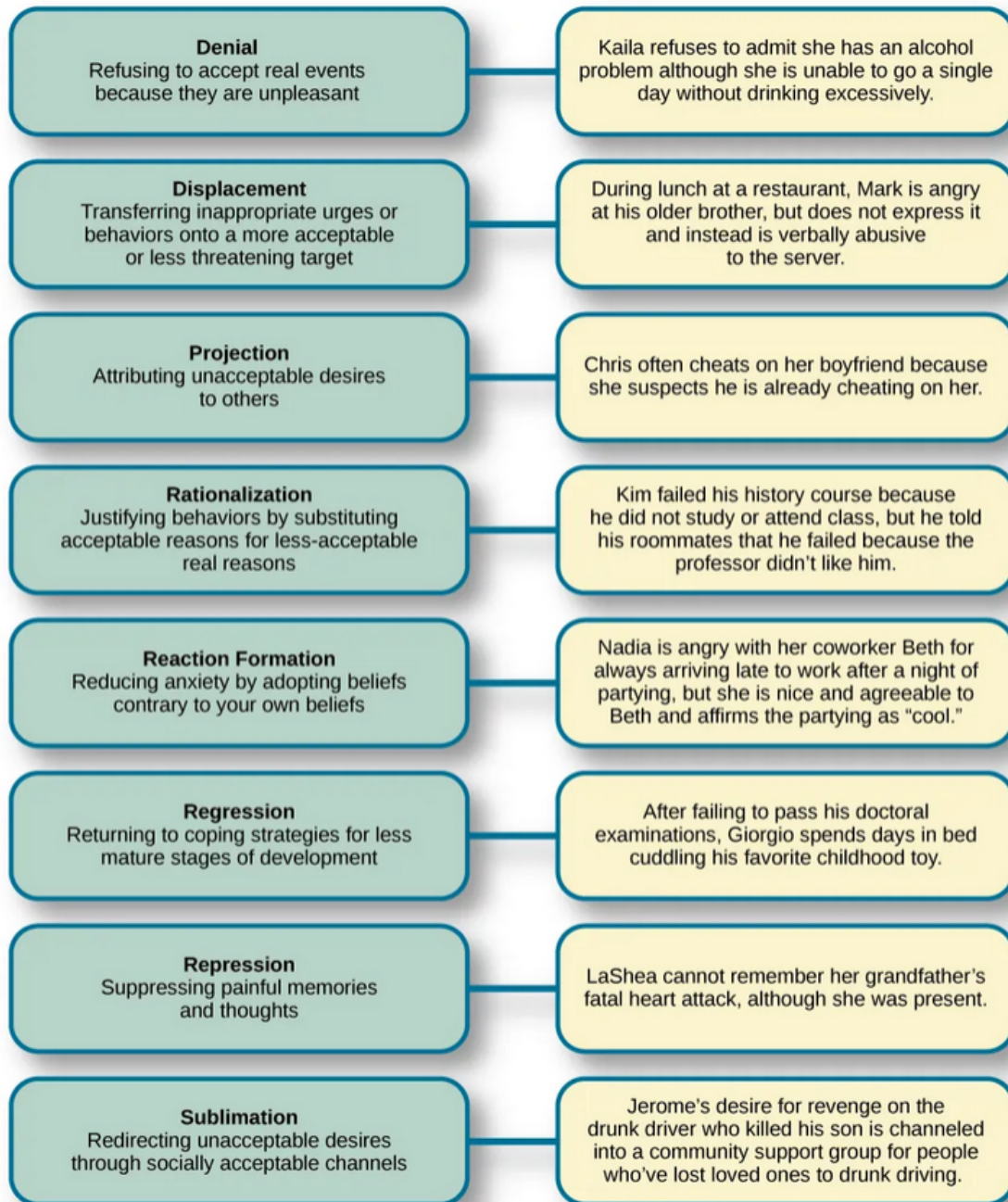
- ☒ A) Id
- ☐ B) Superego
- ☐ C) Ego
- ☐ D) None of the above

Explanation:

- Freud hypothesized that if we are unable to the warring id and superego, we may be in a state of **neurosis**
 - Thus, our can be traced back to the ego trying to moderate the id and superego

3.3 Defense Mechanisms

- Our ego desired a state of anxiety, and thus, may employ unconscious **defense mechanisms**
- There are many types of defense mechanisms that one might employ:



 Discuss: Identify the two possible defense mechanisms being employed in this example: Drake is fighting with his brother, Josh. Earlier that day Drake got both of them stuck in a treehouse by accidentally closing it without a door. Drake insists that he indeed put a hole in the door, despite that being clearly not the case. Then, he insists that he only made the mistake because he was hungry while they were working.

- The [inspiration for the prior question](#)

3.4 Stages of Psychosexual Development

Important

Freud was not just a deviant (well maybe a little in some regards), but his theories came about because of how taboo and repressed sex was as a topic during his time

- Returning to Freud's stages of , recall that he believes that our has later impacts on our life
 - His stages, as we'll cover more in a second, are related to the [erogenous zones](#)

Stage	Age (years)	Erogenous Zone	Major Conflict	Adult Fixation Example
Oral	0–1	Mouth	Weaning off breast or bottle	Smoking, overeating
Anal	1–3	Anus	Toilet training	Neatness, messiness
Phallic	3–6	Genitals	Oedipus/Electra complex	Vanity, overambition
Latency	6–12	None	None	None
Genital	12+	Genitals	None	None

? Which of the following ways would be appropriate to describe Freud's theory of development?

- ☒ A) Continuous
- ☐ B) Discontinuous
- ☐ C) Disadvantageous
- ☐ D) Empirical

Explanation:

- Freud said it is possible to fall into **fixation**

3.4.1 Oral Stage

- The **oral stage** of development is focused on the _____
 - During _____: E.g., sucking on mother's breast, pacifiers, thumbs, etc
 - How _____ occurs: weaning too early or too late, resulting in anxiety
 - During _____ if fixation occurs: E.g., excess smoking, eating, drinking, biting nails

🔊 Discuss: If we say that weaning too early can harm a young child's trust, and inspire mistrust - what theory (and associated theorist) might this conflict be associated with?

3.4.2 Anal Stage

- The **anal stage** of development is focused on the _____ (and bladder)
 - During _____: mastering _____ over toilet training and inhibiting urination and defecation

- How _____ occurs:
 - * Too _____ or harsh parenting → anal- _____
 - * Too _____ parenting → anal- _____
- During _____ if fixation occurs:
 - * Anal-retentive: stingy, stubborn, perfectionism
 - * Anal-expulsive: messy, careless, disorganized

 Discuss: If I am super cheap and very fixated on having an organized workplace, becoming angry when people move things, Freud would say what about the parenting that I had during potty training?

3.4.3 Phallic Stage

- The **phallic stage** of development is focused on the _____
 - Children begin to understand the _____ between sexes
 - During _____: a desire towards the opposite-sex parent, jealousy towards the same-sex parent
 - * In boys: _____ complex, _____ anxiety
 - * In girls: _____ complex, _____ envy
 - How _____ occurs: inability to resolve an understanding of the parent as a non-opponent
 - During _____ if fixation occurs: _____, overly ambitious

 Discuss: Try explaining the conflict in this stage through the vocabulary of the id, the ego, and the superego

3.4.4 Latency Stage

- During this **latency stage**, there is actually a _____ of sexual feelings, as children focus on other pursuits and goals
 - “Latency” means “delay”

3.4.5 Genital Stage

- The **genital stage** of development is, again, focused on the _____
- Compared to the _____ stage, a young adult now redirects the original incestuous feelings from their Oedipus or Electra Complex into desire for more socially _____ partners

! Important

You can't really become 'fixated' at this stage, as it is the final one

3.5 Conclusion

- Freud's thoughts on the ego, superego, id, and all of the stages of psycho-sexual development come back to what type of adult we become, i.e., our _____

! Important

Many developmental theories tie into personality because many theories how that our development is critical for shaping us

? A hot-shot, well-paid lawyer is fantastic at their job, but incredibly self-centered, focused only on their own good by continuing to excel in their career. What stage might Freud say this person is stuck in?

- ☒ A) Oral
☐ B) Anal
☐ C) Phallic
☐ D) Genital

Explanation:

4 Neo-Freudians: Adler, Erikson, Jung, and Horney

4.1 Introduction

- “Neo”-Freudian → “New” Freudians, i.e., those who modified and added to his _____ theory
- Most of these theorists took a _____ role of sex in development, and instead focused on other areas

4.2 Alfred Adler & Individual Psychology

- Alfred Adler place intense emphasis on feelings of _____, i.e., the **inferiority complex**
 - In his perspective, our personality is _____ as a result of trying to “make up” for feelings of inferiority during childhood
- Adler took a more _____ view of development of personality, as our relation to other in society and our feelings of how well we “stack up” determines our personality
 - He talked of **social tasks** that we consider if we feel inferior in
 - * _____ tasks
 - * _____ tasks
 - * _____ tasks
 - Any sense of _____ in the above tasks made lead to a change in personality

 Discuss: Describe a situation in which someone may feel a sense of inferiority in their occupational tasks

4.3 Erik Erikson (Again)

- Erik Erikson also falls into this general neo-Freudian category, as he continued

- the emphasis of the _____, but also place value on the lifespan and social milestones as well
- See prior module notes for more details on his theories
 - Similar to _____, Erikson held that failure in any of the developmental tasks could lead to longstanding issues in traits

4.4 Carl Jung & Analytical Psychology

- Carl Jung provided the new theory of [analytical psychology](#)
 - This was focused on the development of _____ between unconscious and conscious desires
- Jung was also the first to make a disinfection of extroverts and introverts:

Introvert	Extrovert
Energized by being alone	Energized by being with others
Avoids attention	Seeks attention
Speaks slowly and softly	Speaks quickly and loudly
Thinks before speaking	Thinks out loud
Stays on one topic	Jumps from topic to topic
Prefers written communication	Prefers verbal communication
Pays attention easily	Distractible
Cautious	Acts first, thinks later

 Discuss: Would you describe yourself more as an extrovert or an introvert? Give some examples of why you think this way

4.5 Karen Horney & Extension of Psychoanalysis

- Karen Horney was Freudian-trained, but moved her area of interest more toward _____ growth, self-realization, and improving - regardless of childhood issues or development

? Which of these other perspectives had a focus on positive growth?

- ☒ A) Psychoanalysis
- ☐ B) Behaviorism
- ☐ C) Cognitivism
- ☐ D) Humanism

Explanation:

- Because she focused on how we grow past anxiety, she introduced the following _____ styles to explain the different ways we think and behave to _____ our anxiety

Coping Style	Description	Example
Moving toward people	Affiliation and dependence	Child seeking positive attention and affection from parent; adult needing love
Moving against people	Aggression and manipulation	Child fighting or bullying other children; adult who is abrasive and verbally hurtful, or who exploits others
Moving away from people	Detachment and isolation	Child withdrawn from the world and isolated; adult loner

5 Learning Approaches

5.1 Introduction

- Much like the broader perspective of _____, the following theories on personality are mostly related to _____ behaviorism

 Discuss: How does that differ from those perspectives above with Freud and the neo-Freudians? What is one advantage that behaviorism has over these other theories? Hint: think research

5.2 Behavioral Perspective

- As mentioned prior, B.F. Skinner was a _____ behaviorist, i.e., someone who believes all human thoughts, actions, and behaviors are the results of form of conditioning

 Review: which specific type of conditioning was B.F. Skinner often associated with?

- ☒ A) Classical
- ☐ B) Operant
- ☐ C) Observational
- ☐ D) Vicarious

Explanation:

- The behaviorist perspective holds that our tendency to maintain or _____ our personality can be across the lifespan, and is a result of:
 - _____
 - _____
 - _____ learning
 - _____ learning
- Example: I drive fast and recklessly on the road, until I get in a bad car accident which causes me chronic pain - I change my tendencies towards riskiness due to this consequence

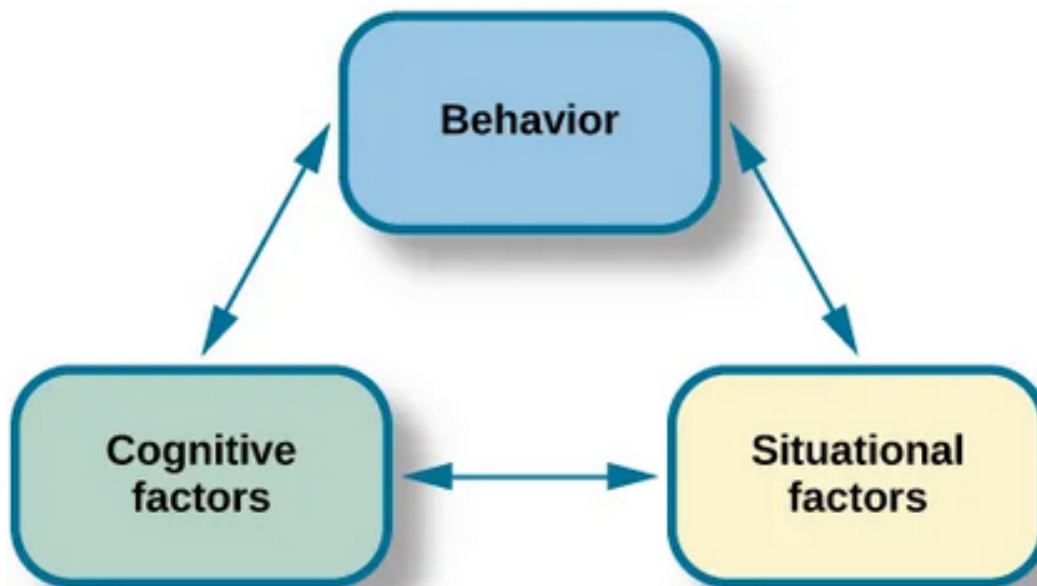
? In the above example, what would we call the pain as a consequence?

- ☒ A) Negative Reinforcement
- ☐ B) Positive Reinforcement
- ☐ C) Negative Punishment
- ☐ D) Positive Punishment

Explanation:

5.3 Social-Cognitive Perspective

- Albert Bandura, another behaviorist held what he called the **social-cognitive theory of personality**
 - This rested upon **reciprocal determinism**



- This is closely related to **observational** learning, and the vicarious punishment/reinforcement that comes with it
 - We **observe** the personalities and actions that we see are rewarded in other people
 - E.g., I see that being a jerk got one guy multiple promotions at my company, thus I become a jerk to succeed as well because it is good

 Discuss: What stage of Kohlberg's Theory of Moral Development might we be at if we judge our morality purely on reinforcement and punishment?

6 Conclusion

6.1 Recap

- There are many competing, but valid, theories of personality that offer explanations for how and why personality develops a certain way
- Each of these theories places value on different areas that may cause long-standing changes in our traits, attitudes, thoughts, feelings, and behaviors
- Many of these theories relate to previous topics, such as development, behaviorism, cognitivism, etc.

Key Terms

A

anal stage The psychosexual development stage in which the endogenous zones are the anus and the bladder [12](#)

analytical psychology A theory / focus of psychology focus on the developing a balance between the unconscious and conscious [16](#)

C

conscious Thoughts, feelings, and memories we are explicitly aware of [7](#)

D

defense mechanism Unconscious protective behaviors by the ego to reduce anxiety between the id and superego [9](#)

E

Ego The unconscious thing that helps compromise between the superego and the id [8](#)

erogenous zone In psychosexual theory of development, an area of the body that gives pleasure to a child [11](#)

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fixation In psychosexual theory of development, the process of becoming 'stuck' during a certain stage, on a certain endogenous zone [12](#)

four-humors theory A historical theory of personality focused on the balance of four humors/fluids [3](#)

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genital stage Final stage of psychosexual development, where a young adult channels their former incestual feelings into appropriate partner [14](#)

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Id The Freudian part of our unconscious that seeks out immediate pleasure and satisfaction [8](#)

inferiority complex Associated with individual psychology and Alfred Adler; tendency to try to make up for feeling of inferiority as a driver to personality [15](#)

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latency stage A stage of psychosexual development in which children are largely unengaged with sexual urges [14](#)

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neurosis A tendency towards negative behaviors, actions, and feelings [9](#)

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phallic stage Stage of psychosexual that focuses on differences between male and female people and develop feelings for one's opposite-sex parent [13](#)

Phrenology theory A historical theory of personality focused on measurements of the skull as indicative of personality traits [4](#)

pleasure principle The id's tendency to seek out immediate gratification [8](#)

R

reality principle The ego's process to satisfy the id in such a manner that it is balanced by the rules of the superego 9

reciprocal determinism The interplay and dependence of behaviors, cognitive factors, and situational factor in the development of our personality 19

S

social tasks Under individual psychology, a set of 3 tasks that need to be met in order to not feel inferior 15

social-cognitive theory of personality Theory of personality associated with Albert Bandura, where learning and cognition both play a role 19

Superego Our 'conscience' and moral compass that helps us moderate our Id, the 'rules' we follow 8

U

unconscious Mental activity, thoughts, feelings, and memories we are not aware of and unable to access 7

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